

The HUMAN Digest 1.2



Greetings. In this issue you will find:

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Welcome to the second issue of the HUMAN Digest. As you browse this issue, you may note that the mainstream press publishes a daily barrage of AI-related articles. We hope to act as a filter for this topic and bring to your attention what is timely and relevant.

As the fall semester approaches, professors are incorporating generative AI tools into the classroom. Students will seek guidance on the use of AI systems either in or outside of class. The College's Writing Center has proffered sample statements to append to syllabi that address the issue of academic honesty. The rapid integration of AI tools presents both a significant challenge and a unique opportunity for educators. While

concerns about academic integrity remain, there's also growing excitement about AI's potential to enhance learning experiences, foster digital literacy, and prepare students for an increasingly AI-driven world.

The HUMAN Digest welcomes feedback at kee@lakeforest.edu

Justin Kee, editor-in-chief

Davis Schneiderman, Principal Investigator, [HUMAN](#) grant

AI and the Humanities

[AI and the limits of language](#). Published just prior to the release of ChatGPT, the authors contend that large language models will never truly *understand* what they are saying.

A faculty artist at Rutgers use AI to [examine](#) American history.

An [opinion](#) piece by Matthew da Mota, offering applications and solutions to the use of generative AI in higher education.

General news

The European Union passed the [Artificial Intelligence Act](#) into law. The Act seeks to categorize risks associated with AI, including the use of biometric systems, and enumerates the regulations that govern such systems. Apart from banning the use of such systems deemed an “unacceptable risk”, the Act requires registration of “high risk” systems and outline transparency requirements for generative AI systems, such as requiring labels on their outputs.

In July, the White House released, “[FACT SHEET: Biden-Harris Administration Announces New AI Actions and Receives Additional Major Voluntary Commitment on AI](#).”

Scientists are using AI tools to design novel [antibodies](#). The tool, RFDiffusion, builds on earlier research in the field, such as [AlphaFold](#), to design antibodies for a particular target.

OpenAI has previewed their text-to-video generative model, named [Sora](#). Described as a world model, which can simulate the physical world. While not generally available, limited access has been granted to a number of [artists and directors](#).

Another perspective

Do LLMs like ChatGPT present an existential risk to humanity? Not so according to [researchers](#) at the University of Bath.

We will check in on this claim in six months or so as new reasoning techniques are deployed to the models.

A useful term

Diffusion model This is a type of generative AI model often used for image generation. The model is trained on a dataset of images with varying levels of noise added. During image generation, the model iterates to gradually change random noise into a coherent image.

People to know

[Fei-Fei Li](#) is a distinguished Professor of Computer Science at Stanford University and the co-director of the Stanford Human-Centered AI Institute. Renowned for her pioneering work in computer vision, she co-created the ImageNet project, a large-scale visual database that significantly advanced deep learning and object recognition technologies. Previously, she served as the Director of the Stanford Artificial Intelligence Lab (SAIL) and was the Chief Scientist of AI/ML at Google Cloud. Beyond her technical contributions, Professor Li is a strong advocate for diversity in AI, founding AI4ALL to promote AI education and opportunities for underrepresented groups.

Go deeper, see her recent book, "[The Worlds I See](#)"

A visualization

Inside a [large language model](#). You can step through a “toy” model (nano-gpt) that sorts letters alphabetically.

Just for fun

[Black Forest Labs](#), a startup founded by the creators of Stable Diffusion, has announced FLUX.1, a new text-to-image model. Try it out [here](#). NOTE: you may need to create an account to access the model.

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HUMANS IN THE LOOP.

Have a tip or suggestion for an upcoming issue of the HUMAN Digest? Write Justin Kee an email at kee@lakeforest.edu.

